Codebook

Place-Based Identity and the Demand for Local Candidates

This codebook documents every variable in the three datasets released with the replication materials. Variables are listed in the order they appear in each file. Question wording is reproduced as fielded, with British spelling in the British survey. Variables constructed in the analysis code are listed at the end of each section.

File	Contents
`ward_jop_yougov_data.sav`	Observational survey, Britain (Table 1; appendix A)
`ward_jop_localcandidates_exp_data.csv`	Survey experiment, United States (all other results)
`ward_jop_pilot_data.csv`	Pilot study, United States (manipulation check, appendix)

1. Observational survey: `ward_jop_yougov_data.sav`

Source. YouGov UniOM omnibus, University of Oxford. Online survey of the YouGov panel, sampled to be representative of adults in Great Britain (18+). Fieldwork 21–22 August 2022. N = 1,793. Analysis variables only. The remaining omnibus variables are not released.

Missing values. Codes 8/98 ("Skipped") and 9/99 ("Not Asked") follow YouGov conventions. "Don't know" is coded 6 on the attitude items and is treated as missing in the analysis.

Variable	Definition	Values
`ID`	Respondent identifier	Integer
`Weight`	YouGov survey weight (age × gender × education, social class, region × 2019 vote, EU referendum vote, political interest). Not applied in the reported models	Continuous
`age`	Age in years	18–98
`gender`	Gender	1 Male; 2 Female
`social_grade`	Social grade of chief income earner	1 A; 2 B; 3 C1; 4 C2; 5 D; 6 E; 7 Refused; 8 Unknown
`education_level`	Highest qualification attained	1 No formal qualifications; 2–14 school, vocational and sub-degree qualifications; 15 University diploma; 16 First degree; 17 Higher degree; 18 Other technical, professional or higher; 19 Don't know; 20 Prefer not to say

Variable	Definition	Values
political_attention	Attention paid to politics	1–11 (0 = no attention to 10 = a great deal)
ONS_urban	ONS urban–rural classification of respondent's area	1 Urban; 2 Town and fringe; 3 Rural; 10 Uncoded
AW_pid1	"Generally speaking, do you think of yourself as Labour, Conservative, Liberal Democrat, or what?"	1 Conservative; 2 Labour; 3 Liberal Democrat; 4 SNP; 5 Plaid Cymru; 6 Green; 7 Other party; 8 None; 9 Don't know
AW_pid2	"If you had to choose, would you say that you are a little closer to the Conservative Party or to the Labour Party?" (asked of those not identifying as Conservative or Labour in AW_pid1; NA otherwise)	1 Closer to Conservative; 2 Closer to Labour; 3 Equally close to both; 4 Don't know
AW_localid_1	"How much do you agree or disagree with the following statements: I feel like I belong to my neighbourhood"	1 Strongly agree; 2 Agree; 3 Neither agree nor disagree; 4 Disagree; 5 Strongly disagree; 6 Don't know
AW_candpref1_1 – AW_candpref1_6	"Imagine that there is a general election taking place and that there is a candidate to be your Member of Parliament (MP) from the **Labour Party**. How important to you would be the following traits in this candidate?" _1 Having a university degree; _2 Having children; _3 Being born and raised in your local area; _4 Living in your local area; _5 Having a job in your local area; _6 Having previous experience in politics	1 Extremely important; 2 Very important; 3 Moderately important; 4 Not very important; 5 Not at all important; 6 Don't know
AW_candpref2_1 – AW_candpref2_6	As above, for a candidate from the **Conservative Party**	As above
Constructed in yougov_uniom_2022.Rmd		
AW_localid_1strong	Place-based identity: agrees or strongly agrees with AW_localid_1	1 Agree/strongly agree; 0 Otherwise; NA Don't know
AW_candpref3_{3--5}strong	Trait rated extremely or very important for either the Labour or the Conservative candidate (Table 1 outcome)	1 Important; 0 Otherwise; NA if neither rating is extremely or very important and either is Don't know
AW_candpref3_{3--5}mean	Mean of the Labour and Conservative ratings, reversed so that 5 = extremely important (appendix, full-scale models)	1–5 in steps of 0.5; NA if either rating is Don't know
noncon2	Not a Conservative identifier or leaner	1 Non-Conservative; 0 Conservative or leaning Conservative; NA Don't know on both items
agec	Age group	1 18–24; 2 25–39; 3 40–64; 4 65+
ABC1	Chief income earner in social grade A, B or C1	1 ABC1; 0 Otherwise

Variable	Definition	Values
`educationc`	Education group	1 No formal qualifications; 2 School, vocational or sub-degree (codes 2–14); 3 University or other higher qualification (codes 15–18); NA Don't know or Prefer not to say
`gender`	Recoded in place	1 Female; 0 Male

2. Survey experiment: `ward_jop_localcandidates_exp_data.csv`

Source. Qualtrics survey fielded to US adults through Prolific, 16–18 April 2025. Preregistered at osf.io/mwbcu. One row per participant (N = 4,803 recruited, before exclusions). Conjoint attributes were randomized in Qualtrics with JavaScript (`conjoint_code_v2.txt`).

De-identification. Prolific identifiers, ZIP codes, timestamps and unused platform variables were removed before release (`ward_jop_data_preparation.R`). ZIP codes were first used to derive state and RUCA code.

Missing values. Conjoint variables are NA for rounds a participant did not reach, and `manipulation_check_1` and `attention_check` are NA for 14 participants who did not answer them. Personal details in the free-text reflections are replaced with bracketed tags (see `treatment`).

Variable	Definition	Values
`ResponseId`	Qualtrics response identifier	String
`Duration (in seconds)`	Time taken to complete the survey	Seconds
`Q_RecaptchaScore`	Google reCAPTCHA v3 score	0–1 (higher = more likely human)
`race`	Respondent race/ethnicity; multiple selections separated by commas	White; Black or African American; Hispanic or Latino; Asian; American Indian or Alaska Native; Native Hawaiian or Pacific Islander; Middle Eastern or North African; Other race or ethnicity; Prefer not to say
`education`	Highest level of education completed	Some high school or less; High school diploma or GED; Some college, but no degree; Associates or technical degree; Bachelor's degree; Graduate or professional degree; Prefer not to say

Variable	Definition	Values
hh_income	Annual pre-tax household income	Less than $25,000; $25,000–$49,999; $50,000–$74,999; $75,000–$99,999; $100,000–$149,999; $150,000 or more; Don't know; Prefer not to say
age	Age in years, from the Prolific profile	18–88; missing for 394 participants
resp_gender	Gender, from the Prolific profile	Female; Male; missing for 394 participants
pid1	Party identification	Democrat; Republican; Independent; Other; Don't know
pid2	Partisan leaning, asked of those answering Independent, Other or Don't know to pid1	Democrat; Republican; Neither; Don't know
state	State of residence, from ZIP code (zipcodeR)	Two-letter state code; NA if ZIP code invalid or unmatched (45)
ruca1	Primary Rural-Urban Commuting Area code of ZIP code (USDA ERS, 2010 ZIP code approximation)	1–3 Metropolitan; 4–6 Micropolitan; 7–9 Small town; 10 Rural; 99 Not coded; NA if ZIP code invalid or unmatched (48)
treatment	Open-ended reflection, treatment condition (neighborhood identity prime). Text of response; NA for control participants. Personal details are replaced with bracketed tags: a street address ([address]), ZIP codes ([ZIP]), names of people ([name], [family name]), and names of streets, neighborhoods, parks and places with fewer than about 100,000 residents where the respondent lives ([street], [neighborhood], [park], [lake], [place], [town], [town nickname])	String
control	Open-ended reflection, control condition (individual identity prime). Text of response; NA for treatment participants. Personal details are replaced with bracketed tags, as for treatment	String
gpt_answer	Hand-coded flag for AI chatbot use in the reflection (common phrasing across respondents, third-person framing, overly formal style)	0 Not flagged; 1 and 2 Flagged (the hand coding used two flag values, and both are excluded)
chosen_profile_q1_round{1--3}	Task 1, "Who would you personally prefer to be your candidate?": name and label of the candidate chosen in each round	e.g. "James (Candidate A)"
chosen_profile_q2_round{1--3}	Task 2, "Who do you think would win the most votes in the general election?": candidate chosen in each round	As above

Variable	Definition	Values
profile{1,2}_round{1--3}	Name and label of candidate A (profile 1) and candidate B (profile 2) in each round. Names are drawn from gendered lists, and candidate gender is recovered from the name in the analysis code	Male: James, Michael, William, John, David. Female: Susan, Jennifer, Emily, Olivia, Barbara
profile{1,2}_education_round{1--3}	Candidate education	High school diploma; Bachelor's degree
profile{1,2}_race_round{1--3}	Candidate race	White; Black; Hispanic
profile{1,2}_family_ties_round{1--3}	Candidate family ties	No / Some / Most extended family live in the neighborhood
profile{1,2}_residence_length_as_adult_round{1--3}	Candidate length of adult residence	Just moved to the neighborhood; Lived in the neighborhood for 5 years; Lived in the neighborhood for 20 years
profile{1,2}_birthplace_round{1--3}	Candidate birthplace	Not born in the neighborhood; Born in the neighborhood
profile{1,2}_residence_round{1--3}	Candidate homeownership	Rents a house in the neighborhood; Owns a house in the neighborhood
profile{1,2}_political_experience_round{1--3}	Candidate political experience	None; State legislator; Congressman; Congresswoman (gendered to match the candidate)
manipulation_check_1	"Thinking about your neighborhood, how much do you agree or disagree with the following statements: I feel like I belong to the neighborhood in which I live." Asked after the conjoint	Strongly agree; Agree; Neither agree nor disagree; Disagree; Strongly disagree; Don't know; NA not answered (14)
attention_check	Attention check instructing participants to choose "Strongly disagree"	As above; participants not choosing "Strongly disagree", including the 14 with NA, are excluded
llm_code	Predominant content of the treatment reflection, coded on 6 October 2026 by Claude Sonnet 5.5 (`claude-sonnet-5-5`) in the Claude desktop app (Cowork), low effort, extended thinking off, using the prompt in `opentext_coding_prompt.txt`	PI place identity; PD place dependence; MX mixed, neither dominant; UNUSABLE off-topic, incoherent or single-word; NA control group
negative	Reflection says people live there despite the area or for lack of alternatives (e.g. "it's the cheapest, there's nothing here"). Coded alongside `llm_code`	1 Negative; 0 Otherwise; NA control group
flag	Coder's note on the LLM code (e.g. "close call", "denies belonging"). Not used in the analysis	Text; NA none
pi_claims	Number of distinct place-identity claims in the reflection, coded by the same model in a follow-up prompt using the same scheme	Count; NA control group

Variable	Definition	Values
pd_claims	Number of distinct place-dependence claims in the reflection, coded as pi_claims	Count; NA control group
human_code	Author's hand code for the validation sample of 303 treatment reflections, using the same scheme	PI; PD; MX; UNUSABLE; NA outside the validation sample
human_negative	Author's hand code of negative for the validation sample	1 Negative; 0 Otherwise; NA outside the validation sample
human_flag	Author's note on the hand code. Not used in the analysis	Text; NA none
Constructed in ward_jop_localcandidates_exp_code.Rmd		
treatment_group	Assigned to the neighborhood identity prime	TRUE Treatment; FALSE Control
pid_lean	Party identification including leaners (pid2 where asked, otherwise pid1); determines the primary shown	Democrat; Republican; Neither; NA Don't know (11)
short_text	Reflection in the bottom decile of length (below 124 characters for treatment, 84 for control)	1 Short; 0 Otherwise
round, task, profile	Conjoint round (1–3), task (q1 preference, q2 electability) and profile (1, 2) in the long data	
chosen	Profile chosen in that round and task (outcome)	1 Chosen; 0 Not chosen
gender	Candidate gender, from candidate name	Male; Female
political_experience	Candidate political experience, Congressman and Congresswoman combined	None; State legislator; Congress
rural_urban_simplified	Urbanicity from ruca1	Rural (10); Town (7–9); Large town (4–6); City (1–3); NA if ruca1 is 99 or missing
manipulation_check_1 (recoded)	Manipulation check as a number, in the sample after exclusions	5 Strongly agree to 1 Strongly disagree; NA Don't know
manipulation_check_1_bi	Expresses place identity on the manipulation check (control-condition analyses, Figure 2)	1 Agree or strongly agree; 0 Otherwise; NA Don't know

Exclusions. The sample after exclusions omits participants who completed in under 60 seconds or more than three standard deviations above the mean duration, have gpt_answer $\neq 0$, have short_text $= 1$, have Q_RecaptchaScore ≤ 0.4, or did not answer "Strongly disagree" to attention_check.

3. Pilot study: ward_jop_pilot_data.csv

Source. Qualtrics survey fielded to US adults through Prolific, 8 December 2023. $N = 56$. Participants received the treatment or control vignette, followed immediately by the manipulation check. Timestamps were removed before release, and one place name in the reflections is replaced with [town].

Variable	Definition	Values
Status	Qualtrics response type	0 Survey response
Progress	Percentage of the survey completed	100 for all participants
duration	Time taken to complete the survey	Seconds
Finished	Completed the survey	1 for all participants
Group	Experimental condition	Treatment; Control
Q3	Open-ended reflection, treatment condition (neighborhood identity prime, wording as in the main study)	String; empty for control participants
Q4	Open-ended reflection, control condition (individual identity prime, wording as in the main study)	String; empty for treatment participants
Q5_1	Manipulation check: "I feel like I belong to the neighborhood in which I live", worded identically to the main study	1 Strongly agree; 2 Agree; 3 Neither agree nor disagree; 4 Disagree; 5 Strongly disagree; 6 Don't know; NA 1 participant
Q5_2	Manipulation check: "I have a lot in common with other people in my neighborhood"	As Q5_1; NA 1 participant
Q5_3	Manipulation check: "I would be sorry if I had to move out of my neighborhood"	As Q5_1